Materuni Hosts — Developer Brief

Oct 23, 2026 · @Adrian Ally Mwaigwisya

Overview

This brief lists everything to fix and build on materunihosts.com, in priority order. The goals are a fast, consistent site that ranks on Google for "Materuni" searches and looks premium.

- **P1 — do first (week 1):** bugs, wrong prices, internal notes visible to the public, image weight.
- **P2 — month 1:** technical SEO, the new Journal (blog), trust and booking features.
- **P3 — months 2–3:** premium redesign of the homepage and tour pages.

The site runs on Astro, with images and catalogue data loaded from Supabase (`experience_catalog`, `site_content`, `site_settings`). Each task has an ID. Please reply with the ID when it's done, and flag any task that needs content (photos, prices, policy text) from us.

Findings come from a review of 12 pages plus a 375 px phone test on 23 Oct 2026.

P1 — Bugs and content corrections

ID	Task	Where	Details	Done when
B1	Fix old prices in the itinerary builder	/itinerary	It shows $75 / $65 / $85 / $110 and an "Ultimate $135" package. Read all prices and names from `experience_catalog`, the same source as /booking.	The itinerary builder lists the same 6 experiences and prices as /booking.
B2	Fix the TZS price guide	Home, /itinerary	It converts old prices ($65–$135). Generate it from current catalogue prices, or show TZS on each card.	Every TZS figure matches a live USD price.

ID	Task	Where	Details	Done when
B3	One duration per experience	/day-trips, /booking, /experiences	Coffee shows 4–5 h on /day-trips but "Full day" in the booking dropdown; Cooking shows 5–6 h vs. "Full day". Store the duration in the catalogue and use it everywhere.	Durations are identical on every page.
B4	Remove internal notes visible to the public	Home, /reviews	Delete: "Host names and approved portraits will be added…", "We will publish verified community-impact figures when…", "We do not publish invented testimonials…" (3 places), "We are building this space…".	None of these sentences appear anywhere.
B5	Remove duplicate items in "includes" lists	/experiences (all languages)	For example, the Mbege tasting appears 3 times on the Waterfall card. Deduplicate the catalogue data.	Each item appears once per card.
B6	Add missing card images	Home (Cooking card), /experiences (Moshi Town card)	Use our own photos (to be supplied).	Every experience card has an image.
B7	Replace Wikimedia hotlinks	/experiences (Rau Forest), /faq, /itinerary	These pull images from commons.wikimedia.org without credit. Replace with our own photos hosted on our site.	No requests go to commons.wikimedia.org.

ID	Task	Where	Details	Done when
B8	Fix review links	/reviews, Home	"Find on Google" and "Leave a Google review" both open the write-review link, and TripAdvisor links to a search. Use the Google Maps profile URL for "Find", and the TripAdvisor listing URL (we'll supply it once claimed).	Each button opens the correct page.
B9	Fix hero button / menu URL mismatch	Home	The hero "Explore day trips" goes to /moshi-day-trips while the menu "Day Trips" goes to /day-trips. Point the hero to /day-trips, or rename the buttons so their destinations are clear.	Button labels match their destinations.
B10	Fix booking form query names	All "Check availability" links	Links pass old names (`Traditional Coffee Experience`, `Camping & Village Life`) that don't match card titles. Use stable catalogue keys (e.g. `?experience=coffee`).	Each link pre-selects the correct experience in the dropdown.
B11	Fix the stray chevron by the menu	Header, mobile	A small "v" sits next to the menu button at the top-right on 375 px.	The header is clean on 375 px.
B12	Map section	Home	The text says "Use the map" but no map is embedded. Embed a lazy-loaded Google Map, or change the wording.	A map shows, or the text no longer mentions one.

P1 — Performance

This is the biggest problem. The server is fast (121 ms response), but images make pages very heavy on mobile data.

ID	Task	Details	Done when
P1	Stop the runtime image swap	The page preloads an optimised WebP (279 KB), then a script replaces `src` with the Supabase original (`hero_image/...materuni-waterfall.jpg`, 2.1 MB). Other originals are 1.7–2.1 MB each (cooking, coffee plantation, community). Render images at build time from optimised files only.	No image over 300 KB loads on any page.
P2	Responsive images	Use Astro `<Image>` / `<Picture>` with `srcset` at 480 / 960 / 1600 px, WebP + AVIF, and correct `sizes`.	A 375 px phone downloads about 480 px images.
P3	Caching	Supabase originals are served with `cache-control: private, no-cache`. Serve images from `/_astro` (hashed, `max-age=31536000, immutable`), or set Supabase objects to public long cache.	Repeat visits load images from cache.
P4	Lazy load below the fold	Only the hero is `eager` with `fetchpriority=high`; all other images are `loading=lazy`.	Lighthouse shows no "offscreen images" warning.
P5	Fonts	Self-host Cormorant Garamond and Manrope, with only the weights used and `font-display: swap`. Preload the heading font.	No request goes to fonts.googleapis.com.
P6	Shorter homepage	The homepage is about 17,600 px tall on mobile. Follow the new homepage structure in P3 — Premium redesign.	Under about 8,000 px on a 375 px screen.

Target: PageSpeed Insights mobile score 85+ on Home, /experiences and /booking. LCP under 2.5 s and CLS under 0.1.

P2 — Technical SEO

ID	Task	Details	Done when
S1	One URL form	Canonicals use a trailing slash (`/booking/`) but every link uses `/booking`. Pick one form (trailing slash recommended), 301-redirect the other, and update all internal links.	No internal link redirects; canonical = the linked URL.
S2	Absolute share images	`og:image` / `twitter:image` are relative on Home, /day-trips and /camping (`/_astro/...`). Make them absolute (`https://materunihosts.com/...`), 1200×630.	Facebook Sharing Debugger shows the image for every page.
S3	Tour schema	`TourOperator` schema already exists. Add `TouristTrip` + `Offer` (price, USD, availability) to each tour page, and `AggregateRating` once real reviews are embedded.	Rich Results Test passes on each tour page.
S4	FAQ schema	Add `FAQPage` schema to /faq and to FAQ blocks on tour pages.	Rich Results Test detects the FAQ.
S5	Sitemap + robots	Generate `sitemap.xml` (including Journal posts) with `@astrojs/sitemap`, and reference it in `robots.txt`.	/sitemap-index.xml lists all pages and is submitted in Search Console.
S6	Translations + hreflang	In `?lang=de` only the H1 is translated; cards and lists stay English. Either translate fully using real paths (`/de/...`) with `hreflang` tags, or remove the language switcher for now.	No mixed-language pages.
S7	Image file names and alt text	Rename `materuni-coffe-plantatio-tour` to `materuni-coffee-plantation-tour`. Every image needs specific alt text, e.g. "Materuni waterfall seen from the forest trail".	No typos; no empty or generic alt text.

ID	Task	Details	Done when
S8	Search Console + Analytics	Verify the domain in Google Search Console and set up GA4 with a `booking_request` event on form submit. Analytics must respect the existing cookie consent.	Both are verified and the booking event shows in GA4.
S9	Thin pages	/chemka-hot-springs and /marangu-day-hike have no prices or photos. Add a "from $X" price, 3 photos and an FAQ block (content to come from us).	Each has a price, images and at least 400 words.

P2 — Journal (blog)

Build a Journal section so we can publish 2 practical posts a month. It's the main way the site will grow through organic search. The existing "Travel guide" page becomes its home.

ID	Task	Details	Done when
J1	Journal index	`/journal/` lists posts newest first: cover image, title, 1-line excerpt, date, reading time. Add category filters: Getting here, Culture & food, Planning, Stories. Redirect `/travel-guide` to `/journal/`.	The index shows all posts and filters work.
J2	Post template	`/journal/<slug>/` with an H1, author + date, cover image, body (H2/H3, tables, images with captions), FAQ block, and a closing "Book this experience" card that links to the related tour + WhatsApp.	The first post renders correctly on mobile and desktop.
J3	Easy publishing	Use Astro content collections (Markdown files) or a Supabase `posts` table with a simple admin form, so a non-developer can publish. Front-matter: title, slug, description, cover, category, related_tour, faqs, published_at.	We can publish a post without editing code.

ID	Task	Details	Done when
J4	Post SEO	Each post gets its own title tag + meta description, `BlogPosting` schema (author, datePublished, image), `FAQPage` schema when it has FAQs, an absolute og:image, and is included in the sitemap.	Rich Results Test passes on a post.
J5	Internal links	Each tour page shows "From the Journal" with 2–3 related posts, and each post links to its related tour. Add "Journal" to the main menu and footer.	Every post is reachable in 2 clicks from Home.
J6	Publish post 1	"How to Get to Materuni Village from Moshi, Arusha and Kilimanjaro Airport". The draft is ready and we'll send it with photos; transport prices are to be confirmed. Slug: `/journal/how-to-get-to-materuni`.	Live, indexed in Search Console.

Next posts (we'll supply the content): Best time to visit Materuni waterfall · What to bring on the Materuni hike · How Chagga coffee is made · What is Mbege? · A rest-day guide for Kilimanjaro climbers.

P2 — Trust and booking

ID	Task	Details	Done when
T1	Live Google reviews	Embed Google reviews (Trustindex or Elfsight, lazy-loaded) on Home, each tour page and /reviews. Show the star rating and count near the hero and booking button.	Real reviews show; no placeholder text.

ID	Task	Details	Done when
T2	Cancellation + payment policy	Add a short policy section to /terms and a 1-line summary near every booking button, e.g. "Free cancellation up to 48 h before" (exact wording from us). List payment methods: M-Pesa, card, cash.	The policy and payment methods are visible before booking.
T3	Online deposit	Integrate Pesapal or Flutterwave to take a 20–30% deposit (M-Pesa + card) after the host confirms availability, via a payment link in the confirmation.	A test deposit completes in sandbox mode.
T4	Confirmation email	An automatic email after a booking request and after confirmation: summary, price, meeting point map pin, what to bring, the host's WhatsApp, and the cancellation policy.	Test bookings receive both emails.
T5	Hosts on About + Home	Add Saidi's and each guide's photo, name and one line. Add TTB / TALA registration numbers to About and the footer (supplied by us).	Real portraits and registration numbers are visible.
T6	Sticky mobile booking bar	On tour pages at ⩽ 768 px, a bottom bar with the price + "Check availability" + a WhatsApp icon.	The bar is visible while scrolling and doesn't cover content.
T7	Slimmer cookie banner	The current banner covers about half the screen on mobile. Use a slim bottom bar with equal Accept / Reject buttons.	The banner is under 25% of the screen height at 375 px.

P3 — Premium redesign

Keep the current brand (Cormorant + Manrope, dark green, gold from the logo). Make it feel premium through big real photography, fewer words, more space and visible trust. Start after the new photos are delivered.

Design rules

- Photography leads: a full-bleed hero with a photo, or a muted 6–10 s video under 2 MB with a poster image.
- One accent colour: gold for buttons only, green for headings, a warm off-white background.
- Each section has one headline, one line of text and one button. Move long text to tour pages.
- Generous spacing (96 px between sections on desktop, 64 px on mobile) and a single column on mobile.
- No more than 3 experience cards on the homepage, plus a link to all experiences.

Homepage order (replaces the current one)

1. Hero: photo or video, headline of 6 words or fewer, "Book your day" button, star rating + review count beneath.
2. Trust strip: TTB registered · Local Chagga hosts · Free cancellation · Pickup from Moshi.
3. Three signature experiences: Waterfall day, Coffee & cooking, Overnight stay. Each card shows a photo, price, duration and button.
4. Meet your hosts: portraits (T5).
5. Reviews: 3 real quotes with name + country (T1).
6. How your day works: 4 steps (pickup, forest walk, coffee + lunch, return).
7. From the Journal: 3 latest posts.
8. Map, a 5-question FAQ and a final booking button.

Tour page template

Top to bottom: photo gallery (5–8 images), then the title, price, duration and rating, then the sticky booking bar (T6). After that: "What you'll do" as 4–6 steps with times, "Included / Not included", meeting point + pickup options, host profile, reviews, FAQ, "From the Journal" and related experiences.

Mobile fixes

- The hero headline currently fills the whole first screen with no image. Put the photo behind the headline and reduce the H1 to about 40 px on mobile.
- All tap targets at least 44 px; body text at least 16 px.

Photos will come from a one-day professional shoot (waterfall, trail, coffee, cooking, camp, host portraits), supplied in horizontal and vertical versions.

Acceptance checklist

Use these checks to confirm the work is complete before handover.

- [ ] PageSpeed Insights mobile 85+ on Home, /experiences, /booking
- [ ] No image over 300 KB on any page (DevTools Network tab, mobile emulation)
- [ ] Prices and durations identical on Home, /experiences, /day-trips, /itinerary, /booking and /faq
- [ ] None of the internal-note sentences in B4 appear on any page
- [ ] Every experience card has its own photo; nothing loads from Wikimedia
- [ ] Each "Check availability" link pre-selects the right experience
- [ ] Facebook Sharing Debugger shows an image for Home, a tour page and a Journal post
- [ ] Rich Results Test passes: TouristTrip (tour page), FAQPage (/faq), BlogPosting (post)
- [ ] Sitemap submitted and pages indexed in Search Console
- [ ] Journal live with post 1; we can publish post 2 without the developer
- [ ] Google reviews widget live with the real rating
- [ ] Cancellation policy and payment methods visible next to the booking buttons
- [ ] Test booking: request email → confirmation email → sandbox deposit paid
- [ ] Language versions either fully translated or switcher removed
- [ ] Site checked on a real Android phone over mobile data

Content we will supply: photos (shoot pending), policy wording, TTB / TALA numbers, host bios, TripAdvisor listing URL, confirmed transfer prices, Journal posts.